Bow Valley College

Course Outline

HCAD1402

The Human Body, Health & Chronic Illness
Winter 2026 - Current

Last Updated: 12/16/2025 8:24:24 AM

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

HCAD1402 The Human Body, Health & Chronic Illness

COURSE DESCRIPTION

In this course, you will study the systems that make up the human body and discuss the milestones of growth and development across a lifetime. You will read about and discuss the most common of the chronic illnesses that you may encounter, and you will learn how to provide safe care based on evidence-informed practices according to the clients' diagnoses, needs, and care plans. The information learned in this course will provide you with care strategies to support the client and the client's family through the process of a client's dying and death. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

REQUISITES	None
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	3
HOURS	45
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Describe knowledge of basic anatomy and physiology (the structure and function of the body systems) with the purpose of having the foundational knowledge to describe common chronic illnesses.	2,8
2	Demonstrate the use of appropriate terminology related to the human body and the HCA role.	1,2
3	Describe knowledge of the basic principles of growth and development across the lifespan.	2,8,9
4	Discuss the aging process (effects on the body systems) and implications for the psychosocial dimension of health.	1,4
5	Analyze personal feelings and experiences as they relate to the aging process, death, and healthy dying.	4,6,8,9
6	Describe characteristics of healthy aging and its relationship to client independence.	4,6,8,9
7	Demonstrate knowledge of common chronic illnesses, including dementia, affecting the aging population.	4,6,8,9
8	Describe the effects of acute and chronic health conditions to diverse clients of various cultural backgrounds.	4,6,8,9
9	Examine chronic pain in relation to chronic conditions.	2,4,8
10	Examine the HCA role and responsibilities in providing person-centred care to clients with chronic conditions across acute and continuing care (home care, long-term care, and supportive living) settings.	4,6,8,9

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Module 1: Body Systems and Functions
Week 2	Module 1: Body Systems and Functions
Week 3	Module 1: Body Systems and Functions
Week 4	Module 1: Body Systems and Functions
Week 5	Module 1: Body Systems and Functions
Week 6	Module 2: Human Growth, Development and Death
Week 7	Reading Week (dates may vary)
Week 8	Module 3: Healthy Aging and Independence
Week 9	Module 3: Healthy Aging and Independence / Module 4: Chronic Conditions
Week 10	Module 4: Chronic Conditions
Week 11	Module 4: Chronic Conditions
Week 12	Module 4: Chronic Conditions
Week 13	Module 4: Chronic Conditions
Week 14	Final Exam

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-10	Final Exam	100%

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this course.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 2 The human body, health & chronic illness. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker–Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

OR

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional References:

Alberta Government. (2019, April 22). Final days overview. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://myhealth.alberta.ca/palliative-care/resources/final-days

Alberta Government. (2018, April). Alberta health care aide competency profile. Retrieved November 9, 2021, from https://open.alberta.ca/publications/9781460137253

Alberta Health Services. (2021). End PJ paralysis. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/Page15971.aspx

Alzheimer's Society of Canada. (2021). About dementia. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/Home/About-dementia

British Columbia. (2020, June 29). *Urinary tract infections (UTIs) in older adults*. Healthlink BC. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.healthlinkbc.ca/illnesses-conditions/infectious-diseases/urinary-tract-infections-utis-older-adults

Canadian Dental Hygienists Association. (n.d.). Seniors' oral health. Dental Hygiene Canada. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.dentalhygienecanada.ca/DHCanada/Seniors/Denture_and_Mouth_Care/DHCanada/Seniors/seniorsOralHealth.aspx

Canadian Dental Hygienists Association. (2012, May 28). Your oral health – A public health issue. Dental Hygiene Canada. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.dentalhygienecanada.ca/DHCanada/Your%20Oral%20Health/DHCanada/Information/Oral_health__you.aspx

Government of Alberta (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 3 Module 2 Human growth and development*. Edmonton, AB: Author.

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 3 Module 3 Healthy aging and independence*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 3 Module 4: Chronic Conditions*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 3: Caring for clients with a diagnosis of dementia*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2019). Course 2: Applying the Person-Centred Care Approach and HCA CARE Principles. Edmonton, AB

Government of Canada. (2019, July 12). *Framework on palliative care in Canada*. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/health-care-system/reports-publications/palliative-care/framework-palliative-care-canada.html#p1.1

Government of Canada. (2011, March 7). *Physical activity*. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/healthy-living/physical-activity.html

Government of Canada. (2014, November 5). *Seniors*. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/healthy-living/seniors.html

Government of Canada. (2015, January 15). *Injury prevention for seniors*. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/public-health/services/health-promotion/aging-seniors/injury-prevention-seniors.html

Government of Canada. (2021, March 5). *Quitting smoking: How to Quit*. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/smoking-tobacco/quitsmoking/how.html

Khan Academy. (2021). *Unit: Human anatomy and physiology*. Retrieved November 9, 2021, from https://www.khanacademy.org/science/health-and-medicine/human-anatomy-and-physiology

McLeod, S. (2018). *Erik Erikson's stages of psychosocial development*. Simply Psychology. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.simplypsychology.org/Erik-Erikson.html

Murray, K. (2014). *Integrating a palliative approach: Essentials for person support workers*. Saanichton, BC: Life and Death Matters.

Wilk, M. (2022). Body Spectrum. *Evolve resources for Sorrentino's Canadian textbook for the support worker*. (5th ed.). https://evolve.elsevier.com

Seven Oaks General Hospital. (2021). Healthy aging. The Wellness Institute. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://wellnessinstitute.ca/healthy-aging/

U.S. National Library of Medicine. (2021, November 2). Aging changes in the nervous system. Medline Plus. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://medlineplus.gov/ency/article/004023.htm

U.S. National Library of Medicine. (2021, November 2). Aging changes in the senses. Medline Plus. Retrieved November 15, 2021 from http://www.nlm.nih.gov/medlineplus/ency/article/004013.htm

World Health Organization. (2021). Palliative care. Retrieved November 15, 2021, from https://www.who.int/cancer/palliative/definition/en/

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or
essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems. Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.